

Tariff Policy and Cross-Border Trade

One-Page Research Brief

Question. Did a tariff-policy event affect Chinese provincial exports to the United States relative to less-exposed destination markets during November 2024-April 2025? Data and unit. The analysis uses a province-destination country-month panel. The committed sample data are synthetic and show the expected structure; real coursework data should be documented but not uploaded if redistribution is restricted. Method. The main specification is a fixed-effects difference-in-differences model. The outcome is log export value. The treatment indicator marks exports to the policy-exposed destination group, and the post indicator marks months after the policy event. Controls include exchange rate, province GDP growth, and inflation where available. Identification logic. The estimate compares changes in policy-exposed trade flows with changes in less-exposed flows before and after the event. The core assumption is conditional parallel trends: in the absence of the policy event, treated and comparison flows would have followed similar paths after fixed effects and controls. Diagnostics. The scripts create a descriptive table, a parallel-trend figure, a baseline DID table, an event-study figure, and a placebo/robustness table. I used these outputs to check whether the DID setup looked reasonable, especially because the sample period is short. Interpretation. This is a course project, so I would not present it as a definitive policy evaluation. The useful parts are the data unit, treatment definition, fixed effects, event-study check, and notes on where the design is weak. What I kept in the public version. The GitHub version keeps the numbered Stata scripts, sample input files, data dictionary, methodology note, and output folders. Restricted course data should stay outside the repo.